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FUNDRAISING

How to build an investor target list

6 steps to a list worth emailing



01

Start with fit and stage

The best investor for you is one who backs your stage, sector and cheque size. A big name who never invests at your stage is a dead end.

02

Find who backed similar companies

Look at who funded companies near yours in the last few years. Funding announcements, company websites and investor portfolio pages show it.

03

Read each investor's own words

Check their site, posts and podcasts for what they say they want. Note the thesis in a line so your outreach can be specific.

04

Sort into tiers

Rank the list by fit and likelihood.

- Tier 1: strongest fit
- Tier 2: good fit, less certain
- Tier 3: worth a try

05

Find the warm path

For each name, look for a mutual connection: a founder they backed, an advisor or a former colleague. A warm introduction beats a cold email.

06

Track it like a pipeline

Keep a simple sheet with investor, fit, contact, last touch and next step. Start with tier 2 to practise before you approach tier 1.

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Save this for later

Share it with a founder who is about to start raising.